US Secretary of State Blinken will meet the PM for a second time today, and President Biden will probably arrive in Israel during the coming week.

The evacuation from the North of the enclave continues under horrible conditions; Israel promises to open a humanitarian corridor. In the North of the country, Hezbollah and Israel appear to be engaging in a war of attrition. This reveals the limits of open Iranian involvement at this stage.

Biden will arrive in Israel on October 18. Some 2,000 American troops will be deployed to the country in an advisory capacity. What this means, nobody knows. As in most wars, much remains under wraps and will likely only become clear when the war is over.

General Petraeus warned Israel about the dangers linked to staying in the enclave after an initial victory. He used Iraq as an example. Staying would quickly become unbearable in casualties and costs; leaving would allow Hamas to reconstitute. Not entering at all would be difficult to justify to the Israeli population, which is eager for a small victory and some weakening of Hamas. An extraordinary conundrum.

Tuesday, October 17

Exchange of fire in the North. The impression is that Hezbollah is preparing to enter the war, if Tehran decides so, and only if Tehran decides so. For the Iranians, the risks may be too high.

Biden’s visit in Israel tomorrow is designed not only as a show of solidarity, which it certainly is, but also as an opportunity to achieve several military, humanitarian, and political goals: avoiding an occupation of Gaza, since it might create a challenging military situation for both Israel and the US; extricating as many Israeli hostages as possible from Hamas’s clutches; deterring Iran from intervening; advocating for a two-state solution to the Israel-Palestine conflict; exhibiting Biden’s humanitarian side to the progressive members of the Democratic Party, with an eye on next year’s